

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken– to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analyses (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DCCED

Date: 5/19/2026

Bill Number: SB 29

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS): Big Game Comm. Svs Bd/BD Dental Examiners

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☒ SIGN ☐ VETO ☐ LWOS

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

Please be specific.

The Big Game Commercial Services Board (BCGSB) needs an executive administrator because the level of work required by its staff is higher than a Licensing Examiner 3 can provide. In addition to its general written and practical examinations, the BGCSG also has specific examinations for each of its 26 guide use areas. All 28 of these exams need to be kept current – a task that the BGCSB has been unable to keep up with over the past decade. Additionally, due to the nature of this industry, the majority of the board members – especially those with expertise in the industry – tend to be out of service and unreachable during primary hunting seasons (spring, summer, and fall), making it essential that the board be able to delegate authority to a qualified staff member to issue licenses, address examination issues, etc.

The Board of Dental Examiners (DEN) has been seeking legislation for a few years to create an executive administrator for their program, which the division agrees is necessary for this program due to its complexity – due to the high number of specialty dentist licenses, sedation permits, dental assistant certificates, and dental hygienist certifications/endorsements it issues in addition to dentist and dental hygienist licenses. This creates a lot of work, not only to review the applications and approve licenses, but also to maintain and update relevant regulations as needed; a task that the DEN has fallen behind on due to the voluntary nature of their board

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members. Additionally, the DEN reviews a very high volume of applications each month, and because of the volume, it can often create a bottleneck and extended processing times in the issuance of dental licenses.

Creating EA positions for these two boards aligns with the Governor’s priorities because it streamlines licensure, removes unnecessary barriers and delays to getting to work in Alaska, and will help these programs do a better job of updating (and removing unnecessary) regulations more timely. Additionally, these positions are funded through licensing fees, so this will not create any additional costs for the State.

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

This legislation creates a range 23 partially exempt Executive Administrator position for the Big Game Commercial Services Board (“BGCSB”) and under the HCS adopted by (H)FIN, now also creates a range 23 partially exempt Executive Administrator position for the Board of Dental Examiners (“DEN”).

The BGCSB was able to obtain funding for a range 23 Executive Administrator in the first year of the 33rd legislative session, and as a result, a temporary exempt range 23 Executive Administrator position was created and filled earlier this year. This legislation would simply codify the position and its range into law to ensure that it continues into the future.

As noted above, the creation of the EA positions should benefit the licensees within the respective programs because it will streamline licensure and ensure they can receive higher level support more timely, and it will allow for the division to retain institutional knowledge for longer than we generally do with Licensing Examiner 3s.

Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

Section 1 Amends AS 08.36.070 – *Dentistry: **duties and** [GENERAL] powers **of board*** – to require the Board of Dental Examiners to establish the qualifications and duties of the executive administrator (EA) and to delegate authority to the executive administrator as necessary to conduct board business.

Section 2 Adds a new section AS 08.36.072 – *Dentistry: executive administrator of the board* – to require the department, in consultation with the board, to employ an executive administrator to perform duties as prescribed by the board. The executive administration is a partially exempt range 23 position.

Section 3 Adds a new subsection (c) under AS 08.54.591 – *Big Game Guides and Related*

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Occupations: creation and membership of board – to require the department, in consultation with the board, to employ an executive administrator to perform duties as prescribed by the board. The executive administrator is a partially exempt range 23 position.

- Section 4 Amends AS 08.54.600(a) – under *Big Game Guides and Related Occupations: duties of board* – to require the board to establish qualifications and duties of the board’s executive administrator employed under AS 08.54.591(c) (created by Section 1) and delegate authority to the executive administrator as necessary to conduct board business.
- Section 5 Amends AS 39.25.120(c) – under *State Personnel Act: partially exempt service* – to add the executive administrators of the Board of Dental Examiners and the Big Game Commercial Services Board to the State positions that are partially exempt.

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

- Companion – none
- Rider – part of HB 197 by Rep. Tomaszewski: creation of the EA for the dental board.
- Amendments – adding the creation of the EA for the dental board sponsored by Rep. Tomaszewski.

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phones numbers of those who testified in support or in opposition of this bill.

Support:

- Alaska Professional Hunters Association, Sam Rohrer, President, (907) 929-0619
- Big Game Commercial Services Board Chair – contact through CBPL Director Sylvan Robb at (907) 465-2524 or Sylvan.Robb@alaska.gov
- Board of Dental Examiners (for HB 197) – contact through CBPL Director Sylvan Robb at (907) 465-2524 or Sylvan.Robb@alaska.gov
- Safari Club International Alaska Chapter, John Sturgeon, President, (907) 230-0072, (907) 903-8329, (907) 980-9018, president@aksafariclub.org

Opposition: None

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information

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of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

It may be unnecessary to do a bill signing since the Big Game Commercial Services Board's executive administrator position was already created as a temporary position a few years ago.

Commissioner's Signature:


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Date: 5/21/2026

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor's Legislative Office for consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

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